

FOR OWNERS

2026 · W32

SEWANG

SEWANG LIQUOR

Alone, Light, Late

3 Faces of August Guests

August liquor trend report for owners
— search data, Instagram & industry news on
your next guest

Surging Keywords

Instagram Watch

August Playbook

Week 1, August 2026 · Published Wed 8/5

DEAR OWNERS

Layer the numbers, and August guests come down to three words.

We layered three months of search data, this weekend's Instagram posts, and industry news.

Three conclusions — **Alone** (solo-drinking & izakaya searches at record highs), **Light** (low-ABV & non-alc surging), **Late** (cross-industry players* chasing the second round). We turn these into menu and ordering moves for your venue.

* **Cross-industry players:** businesses whose core trade isn't alcohol — fast food chains, convenience stores, hotels.

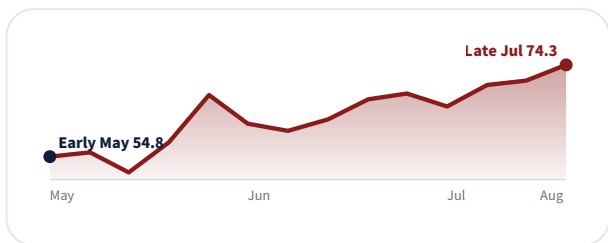
PART 1

Alone — Search Moved First

3 months of Naver search (May–early Aug)
— izakaya & solo drinking both set records

Solo Drinking +36% — Alone Is a Market

Naver search — late July vs. early May, a steady climb



THE SOLO BAR EVOLVES

This week's press spotlighted '**fast friend**' **socializing** at solo bars — solo guests mingling in 10-minute rounds. The solo bar is shifting from '**a place to drink alone**' to '**a social space you can enjoy alone**'. An opening for venues with bar or counter seats.

Izakaya Hits a 3-Month High

Naver search — last week of July set the period's peak

+19%

'Izakaya' searches vs. June low



INSTAGRAM · THIS WEEKEND

Recent #izakaya posts pair **new-opening news with Tokyo travel photos** — demand for Japanese vibes hasn't peaked yet. Sewang partner **Yakitori Zanzan (Gyodae)** also appeared on foodie accounts.

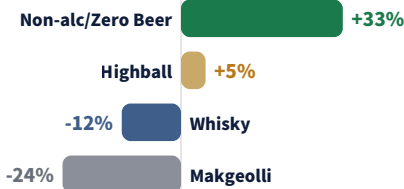
PART 2

Light — How the Market Is Moving

New products and marketing prove the
keywords — late July to early August

The Scale Tips Toward 'Light'

Search change by category — late July vs. early May



Naver DataLab · weekly search, 2026.5.1–8.2

FLIP IT AROUND

Highball searches didn't stall — it simply **became a default menu item**. Growth energy is now moving to **non-alc and low-ABV**.

Soju at 15.7% — ABV Keeps Falling

Late-July launches & renewals — all 'lower, less sweet'



Big-2 soju, both 15.7%

Chum-Churum & Saero —
racing to the low-ABV floor

15.7%



Sunyang Peach Oolong

Zero-sugar fruit soju · in CVS
from 7/22

12%



Horoyoi Lemon Mikan

Summer-only sparkling · late-
July launch

3%



Soonhari Jin (RTD)

Fruity RTD — annual sales near 2X

RTD

TAKEAWAY

From 30% in the 1970s to **15.7%** in 2026. The default guest now comes **for the mood, not to get drunk.**

Instagram Is a Non-Alc Billboard

We opened the 14 latest #nonalcoholicbeer posts ourselves

13/14 posts

brand-sponsored / ad posts

All the same major brand — an all-out SNS push into home drinking

'Can't-drink moments' repeated across sponsored captions

after bedtime

driving

pregnancy

post-workout

dieting

camping

THE VENUE'S OPENING

The market is headed from ₩70.4B to ₩94.6B, yet big brands only target the home — **serving the 'sober guest' in venues is wide open**. Stocking one non-alc option is instant differentiation.

PART 3

Late — The Battle for the Second Round

Fast food, CVS, hotels — cross-industry raids on late-night rounds, and how venues defend

Cross-Industry Players Eyeing the 2nd Round

Fast food, CVS and hotels are taking the 'second glass'



Fast-food 'After Hours'

8–10pm: all beer & highballs 1+1 — aimed at round-two culture



CVS summer liquor wars

Canned-beer bundles & import promos ramp up



Hotel night poolside

Night pass + bottomless drinks — the 'resort round' productized

THE VENUE FIGHTS BACK

What they can't sell is **the temperature of the moment** — fresh-pulled draft, a highball mixed before your eyes, food pairing. But venues now also need **a reason to come late** (late happy hour, round-two sets).

PART 4

Your Venue's August Plan

Alone · Light · Late — turning three
currents into menus and orders

5 Things August Guests Look For

1

A seat that's easy alone

A bar/counter corner — solo guests return more often

2

Light soju & low-ABV, ~15%

15.7% renewed soju, fruit soju, low-ABV sparkling

3

One non-alc, always stocked

Drivers & health-minded guests raise a glass too — defend spend-per-head

4

A highball only you serve

Now that it's a default, differentiate with a signature pour

5

A reason to come after 10pm

Late happy hour & round-two sets — don't cede it to outsiders

Your Venue — How Many Boxes?

Fewer than 3? Time to review your August menu

- ☐ We have **seats where solo guests feel at ease**
- ☐ A **~15% low-ABV** option is on the menu
- ☐ **Non-alc** is always in the fridge
- ☐ At least one **signature highball**
- ☐ There's **a reason to visit after 10pm**

SEWANG CAN HELP

Low-ABV & non-alc assortment, signature recipes, August order volumes — **your rep will rework the menu with you.**

CLOSING

Guests are already moving — alone, light, and late.

Izakaya and solo-drinking searches hit record highs, ABV has slid to 15.7%, and outsiders are hunting the late-night round. For your August menu and orders, Sewang stands ready with data and stock.

Data: Naver DataLab search trends (2026.5.1–8.2, weekly, relative within group) · Instagram hashtag analysis (60 latest posts across 4 tags, collected 2026.8.1–8.3) · non-alc market size per Euromonitor (₩70.4B in 2024 → ₩94.6B by 2027E) · industry news roundup (Edaily, Seoul Shinmun, Newsis, JoongAng et al., 2026.7.16–8.3). Directional reference only.

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2026-W32